

17 The future with “going to”

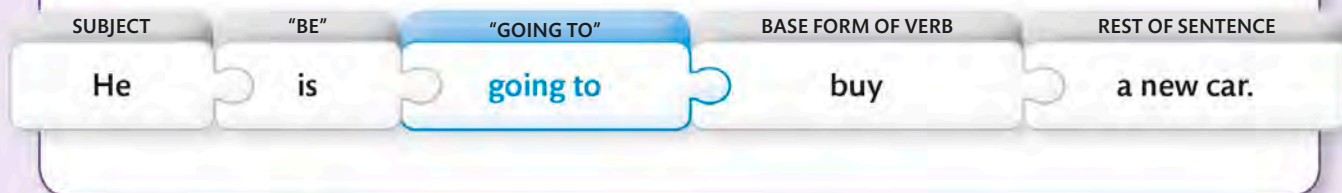
Future forms in English are formed using auxiliary verbs. One of the most commonly used constructions is “going to” plus the base form of the main verb.

See also:

The future with “will” 18

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17.1 HOW TO FORM THE FUTURE WITH “GOING TO”



17.2 “GOING TO” FOR FUTURE PLANS

“Going to” is used to talk about future events that have been planned in advance, rather than decided upon at the time of speaking.

I’m **going to** buy a new car.

Base form of verb.



We are **going to** cook dinner tonight.

“Be” matches the subject of the sentence.

“Going to” doesn’t change with the subject.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

I’m **going to** start reading this book soon.



Sam’s **going to** get fit before his next birthday.



I’m **not going to** eat any chocolate this month.

“Not” is added after the verb “be” to make the negative.



We’re **going to** cycle from Boston to Cape Cod next weekend.

